

▼ **Lakakare charms** from Papua New Guinea are coconuts carved into pigs or marine creatures and filled with magical substances to ward off evil spirits. This one has a swordfish jaw attached.



The fiber bag makes the charm easy to carry

The coconut shell is carved into a stylized face shape



◀ **Worry dolls** are worn in Guatemala and Mexico. The dolls are believed to share the owner's worries with the Mayan Princess Ixmucane, daughter of the sun god, who, legend has it, gave her the gift of taking away people's problems.



▲ **The Star of David** is an ancient Jewish magical symbol comprising two overlaid equilateral triangles. In pendant form, such stars are still used as talismans.



▲ **St. Christopher medallions** are travelers' talismans as the saint is believed to have carried the baby Jesus safely across a river on his shoulders.



▲ **Maneki neko** are Japanese charms in the form of lucky beckoning cats that have a paw raised to summon good fortune to the owner.



▲ **Chinese bi** are symbols of heaven, often shaped into a disk. *Bi* are believed to bring wealth, a long life, and good luck from divine forces.



▲ **This Native American birth fetish** in the form of a beaded turtle contains a lock of both parents' hair and the baby's umbilical cord. It is designed to bring good luck and health to the child.

Modern talismans

Talismans are believed to give the owner extra power or good fortune and include objects as diverse as King Arthur's legendary sword Excalibur or a sports club's lucky mascot. Originally, talismans were made specially for an individual and were given intrinsic powers through magical ritual, but many are now mass-produced and people believe their power comes from what they symbolize.